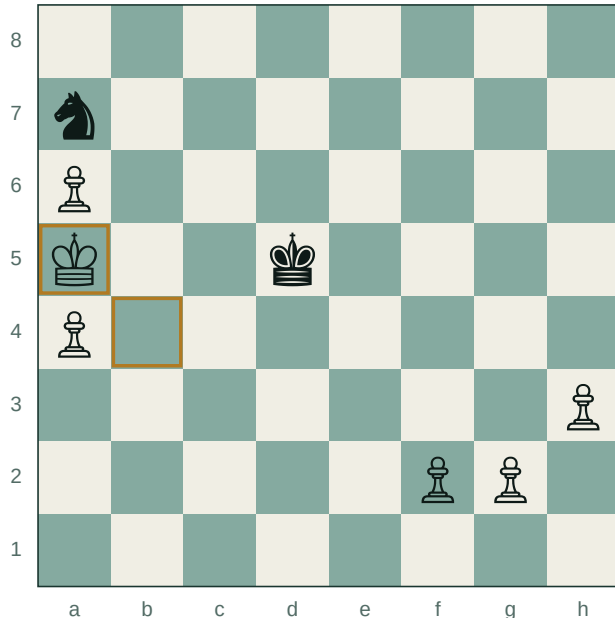


Knight-ending routes: Black, move 53

Knight-ending routes

Black to move



Previous move: 53.Ka5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

53...Kc5 54. f3 Nc6#

53...Kc5 The king moves from d5 to c5. Recorded reply: **54.f3**.

54...Nc6# Mate: knight on c6 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on a5. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Knight on c6. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A knight changes color with every move and may need a detour. Check the route square by square before trusting a race estimate.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Knight endings reward exact route calculation. Forks can change a pawn race, while a distant passer may outrun the knight's short-range movement.

HOW TO LOOK

Map the knight's checking moves and its route to the critical blockade square. Count moves rather than judging distance by appearance.

The defending king is on a5. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.